

Zhonhen — Interview Day One-Pager

The five-minute scan: TRU vs SST, the density argument by buyer, ERCOT, and the landmines

Prepared 22 August 2026 · Compressed from zhonhen-strategy-report.md · zhonhen-lesson-plan.md · zhonhen-deck-summary.md ·
Classification Internal — interview preparation
Handling The Schneider Electric relationship is a confidential disclosure — raise it only with Zhonhen, never elsewhere

The five-minute scan. Reasoning and citations: [zhonhen-strategy-report.md](#) · [zhonhen-lesson-plan.md](#) · [zhonhen-deck-summary.md](#).

Open with this

"The West's own roadmap reaches your core product last — NVIDIA's MV-to-DC power block is the 2029 rung of its ladder, and you've been shipping that rung since the Alibaba co-development. The strategy isn't to win the SST future; it's to monetise 2026 through 2029."

Their ladder: power racks 2H 2026 → row power centres 2027 → MV-to-DC blocks incl. SST 2029.

Say TRU, never SST

Panama is a **transformer-rectifier unit**. Schneider's 800VDC paper says MV conversion happens "by SST or TRU" — same slot, different device class, and an engineer will catch the conflation.

	TRU — WHAT ZHONHEN SHIPS	TRUE SST — THE 2029 DEVICE
Isolation	Line-frequency 50/60 Hz, iron core	~kHz through a small high-frequency core
Switches	Commodity, on the LV side	MV-rated SiC, switching at medium voltage
Power flow	Essentially one-way	Bidirectional by design
Grid role	A load	Active interface — reactive power, voltage regulation, fault-current limiting
Status	Shipping since 2019, fleet history	Roadmap item

Why the precision helps you: "mature magnetics, shipping today" is the stronger card. If they want an SST you are selling the wrong thing; if they want megawatts on the floor in 2027, the line-frequency transformer is the **feature** — the part nobody has to qualify.

ERCOT wrote your sales narrative

NOGRR282 + NPPR1308, binding 1 Aug 2026. Large Computational Load = ≥75 MW, ≥50% computational. Ride through 0.50–0.80 p.u. ≥0.5 s and 0.20–0.50 p.u. ≥0.25 s, back to ≥90% draw within 2 s, current ≤125% — **disturbance-counting trips banned**. Not retroactive (pre-14 Nov 2025 exempt → sell new builds); stricter tier after 1 Jan 2028. National next: FERC ordered standards 16 Jul 2026, Phase I due 31 Dec 2026. Behind it: Fairfax ~1.5 GW self-disconnected, Ashburn/PJM >3 GW, ERCOT 26 events >100 MW.

"Batteries on the DC busbar means we comply by construction — I'd make the NOGRR282 envelope the acceptance test of every pilot."

473 kW/m³ — and who to say it to

1 MW sidecar, 800 × 2200 × 1200 mm = 2.112 m³ → **473 kW/m³**, 98.5%, **150 A/μs** load response, 30 × 33 kW rectifiers + 125 kW DC/DC, with 8 × 160 kW CBU + 8 × 125 kW BBU **inside the same cabinet**.
Neoclouds convert capital into GPU-hours, and that ranks everything: ① **time-to-revenue** (GPUs depreciate against signed delivery dates) → ② **density** (every m³ of power plant is a m³ not earning) → ③ **ride-through** (a sag costs work back to the last checkpoint, and is now law) → ④ TCO per GPU-hour → ⑤ vendor pedigree, which they care about *least* — the reason your door exists at all.
473 answers ② and ③ in one number: more of the hall earns, *and* the compliance buffer costs no extra floor. The AC alternative bolts on separate capacitor shelves and Megapacks that eat white space they are already paying for.

BUYER	REALITY	LEAD WITH
Tenant neoclouds — CoreWeave, Lambda, Nebius	Lease; the landlord owns the MV gear. All three named by NVIDIA as 800 V design pioneers	473 kW/m³ . Charged by footprint, and they buy the rack-side chain — sidecar, shelf, PSU
IREN — target 1	Owns its ERCOT substations and lists no electrical vendor publicly ; Sweetwater 2.75 GW energising from Apr 2026, Childress 750 MW	Schedule + ERCOT compliance . Weeks vs a 30–40-month transformer queue. Pitch a pilot MVR container on one Sweetwater building
Crusoe — target 2	Off-grid / behind-the-meter; Abilene 1.2 GW on its own generation. Bought 29 aeroderivatives purely because combined-cycle ran ~7 years	Generator protection . No system inertia off-grid, so GPU swings hit the gensets directly; storage at four depths on one DC bus smooths what they see
Core Scientific, TeraWulf — wave 2	Brownfield conversions with MV already in place and brutal retrofit schedules against anchor leases	The no-shutdown retrofit into halls whose power chain is being rebuilt anyway
xAI — deprioritise	Best technical fit on paper, worst political fit: inside SpaceX, a defence contractor mid-IPO	Walk away, and say so yourself . Naming the hard stop reads as judgment and saves a year

Landmines — volunteer none, survive all

IF RAISED	WHAT HOLDS
NVIDIA partner roster	Zhonhen is on neither the May nor Oct 2025 list, and denied signed hyperscaler agreements in Aug 2025. Never imply membership — the architecture claim survives on its own
The gated whitepaper quote	<i>"simpler and highly familiar design"</i> is publicly unverifiable . It stays inside Zhonhen conversations and never goes in front of a customer
CATL	49% of the holding company , not the listco; Bao Xiaoru chairs. In the US it stays behind the architecture — battery-agnostic products, FEOC/1260H-clean options, CATL as balance sheet and never the badge on the door
No US entity, UL listing or reference site	True, and conceding it is the move. The wedge is regulatory physics plus schedule, not ecosystem membership — saying exactly where each claim ends is what reads as command
Tariffs	The calendar beats the tariff: a tariffed, factory-built skid available in weeks beats a 30–40-month domestic transformer queue. Model landed cost per deal
Security review / Chinese vendor	Real, and it is why segmentation is ruthless: commercial neoclouds and landlords first, xAI and federal-adjacent never
Founder's Dec 2025 conviction	You never raise it . Not with Jacky, not with anyone

Numbers cold

240 / 336 / 800 Vdc · 10 kV China MV, 12.47–34.5 kV US · Panama **10 kV** → **240/400/800 Vdc in one stage**, >97.5%, 2.5 MW per block · SuperX 3.6 MW at 98.5% · sidecar **473 kW/m³** at 150 A/μs · 100 kW shelf at 96 A/μs (say "100", not 108) · 18 kW PSU at 16 A/μs · NVIDIA 800 V: **+157% power through the same copper, -45% copper, ~+5% efficiency, -30% TCO** · racks 120–150 kW today → ~600 kW Kyber 2H 2027 → 1 MW-class · conversion stages **7–8 legacy / 5 HVDC / 3 Panama** · US 2026: 7,000–9,000 MW new DC capacity, **\$68.6 B of the ~\$95 B prefab market** · Zhonhen generations **2010** → **2019** → **2025**.

Close with the question that shapes everything

Jacky only — the Schneider Electric relationship is his confidential disclosure and does not exist outside that room. Their own 800VDC paper says MV conversion happens by SST or TRU, and they ship **neither**; Red Oak integrates prefab power centres by the hundred against a \$700 M US factory spend; Vertiv is already reported to ship 800 V HVDC built on a Chinese subcontractor. A Zhonhen TRU inside a Schneider-branded power centre solves brand, certification and service in one structure. So ask:

"Is the Schneider conversation at the component layer, the integrated-block layer, or certification?"

The answer determines the entire shape of the US go-to-market — and asking it separates someone who read the deck from someone who understands the business.